



MANDAR DEODHAR

YEH RISHTA KYA KEHLATA HAI

STAR PLUS

A conventional show on arranged marriages. Started on January 12, it became top-rated in June. With its elaborate *Hum Aapke Hain Koun*-kind rituals, it is likely to keep the wedding junkies hooked.

COLORS

girl child. Premiered on March 9, Ammaji's daughter-in-law have made sure it remains in the top 10.



the story of the contemporary Indian woman, who is still not sure how society will handle her sexuality. Not surprising then, a majority of the ads in such shows are either for the morning after pill or flavoured condoms, both shifting the burden of contraception on to the man. It's this hypocrisy that allowed the audience engage with Sawant, when she was just a wannabe motor-mouth. But as soon as that same girl decided to spice things up and get married on prime time, many shifted in their comfortable seats. "We asked ourselves, would people want to watch Sawant get married on TV? And the answer was yes," says Shailja Kejriwal, creative head, NDTV Imagine. The idea for the show came from Sawant, who had worked with the production house SOL on *Nach Baliye*. The show was shot at Udaipur's Fatehgarh Palace with 16 prospective grooms whom Sawant chose from over 12,000 applicants. Apart from raking in TRPs and buzz, this one reality show has become NDTV Imagine's saviour. To make sure that the audience remains attentive, incidents like one of the contestants, Arther Parvez, declaring that he was already married have been thrown in as was a controversy over Manmohan Tiwari's ex-girlfriend.

Till just over 18 months ago, though, there was no such high drama, with Star Plus being undisputed number one. But along came Colors in July 2008, creating a bang with *Khatron Ke*